Operation Rah-e-Rast (2009)

Operation 'Rah-e-Rast' was launched after Sufi Muhammad severed the peace deal unilaterally, after 53 days, brokered with the government on 16 February 2009 to end the Taliban-driven insurgency in Swat. Sufi wanted to nominate Qazi/judges of his own choice and rejected government nominations. The Tehreek-e-Nifaz-e-Shariat-e-Mohammadi (TNSM) and the Taliban chapter of TTP jointly launched brutal offensives against innocent people, police and government and security officials in Malakand Division. Swat had already fallen in February 2009. The government finally launched military operation Rah-e-Rast in early May 2009. During Operation 'Rah-e-Rast', the army ruthlessly eliminated Taliban who put up a stiff resistance. Learning from the defeat in the operation, the battle-hardened Taliban embraced a classic guerrilla tactic of 'retreat and advance' to evade extinction and elimination. By 30 June 2009, the security forces swept the area clean of Taliban and militants by killing 1,635 terrorists; eliminated their camps and hideouts and recovered huge caches of American-, Russian- and Indian-made weapons that were smuggled in from Afghanistan. The operation was successful in dismantling the terrorists in 60 days.

Maulvi Fazlullah escaped to Afghanistan in the aftermath of the military operation. Maulvi Fazlullah's escape to Afghanistan and failure to eliminate other members of his leadership was the major low point of the operation as these were the declared priority of the operation. The biggest success of the operation was that it dismantled the militants' network in the Malakand Division within 60 days (Rashid, 2009).

Operation Rah-e-Nijat (2009)

Operation 'Rah-e-Nijat', an air and ground offensive, was commenced on 17 October 2009 to take control of the areas in South Waziristan under the sway of Baitullah Mehsud (*BBC News*, 17 October 2009). Command and control system of TTP was disrupted in the key Mehsud areas of South Waziristan. By January 2010, Pakistan forces had almost cleared several villages in South Waziristan and seized heavy weapons from the Taliban. No important Taliban leaders were killed or arrested in the offensive. Some assistance was sought from CIA and the US military. The main objective was to disrupt and destroy the strongholds of TTP in Ladha, Makin, Sararogha (Ali, 2009).